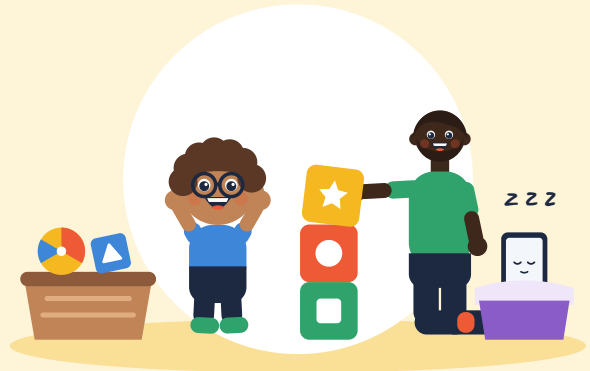


FREE STARTER

# 7 Days of Play First

Seven easy plays, a screen-spot plan and a tracker.  
Nothing to buy, nothing to ban.



## Our screen spot

Same time, same place, same ending, every day. Never a prize, never a punishment.

When

Where

What

How it ends

**How it ends, every day:** a warning (“Two more minutes, then the tablet goes to sleep”), a clear ending (the episode ends or a timer rings) and a landing (“Now we go outside”).

## 7-day tracker

1

Say-what-you-see walk

☐ played  
☐ spot kept  
☆ again!

2

Stop and go dance

☐ played  
☐ spot kept  
☆ again!

3

Tuck in the tablet

☐ played  
☐ spot kept  
☆ again!

4

Basket surprise

☐ played  
☐ spot kept  
☆ again!

5

Ready, set... go!

☐ played  
☐ spot kept  
☆ again!

6

Color hunt

☐ played  
☐ spot kept  
☆ again!

7

Blanket hideout

☐ played  
☐ spot kept  
☆ again!

Every play follows our published safety rules: a grown-up is always there; nothing small enough to fit through a toilet-paper tube for under-3s; no balloons for under-8s; water play always supervised. Parent education, not medical advice.

# One a day, all with things you have



## Say-what-you-see walk

From 12 months · No prep · No mess

Walk slowly through your home or down the street together. Stop wherever your child looks and put it into words: the door, the dog, the big truck. Wait a moment so your child can point, sound or talk back.

**“You’re looking at the truck. Big truck. Beep, beep!”**

**2-minute version:** Sit by a window for two minutes and name what goes by. **Safety:** Hold hands near roads and driveways. Keep little fingers away from outlets and anything hot.



## Stop and go dance

From 15 months · No prep · No mess

Play a song and dance together. When you stop the music, everyone freezes. Hold the pause a little longer each time, then start again with a big “Go!”

**“Ready... set... (wait) GO!”**

**2-minute version:** Sit on the floor and do stop-and-go clapping. **Safety:** Clear a space away from sharp furniture corners and stairs.



## Tuck in the tablet

From 18 months · No prep · No mess

When screen time ends, let your child switch the device off and “tuck it in” with a dish towel in its basket or drawer. Sing a tiny goodnight song together, then say what you’ll do next.

**“Night-night, tablet. See you tomorrow! Now... let’s go PLAY!”**

**2-minute version:** Just say, “Night-night, tablet,” and hold out your hand. **Safety:** Switch the device off first and never cover a device while it is charging. Grown-ups handle chargers and cords, and keep them out of reach of young children.



## Basket surprise

From 12 months · 2-min prep · No mess

Cover the basket with a towel. Pull out one thing at a time, slowly, with a big “Ooh, what’s this?” Pause and let your child guess or reach. Play with it together for a moment, then pull out the next.

**“What’s in here? ... (wait) ... A spoon! Bang, bang.”**

**2-minute version:** Pull out one thing and ask, “What could this be?” Go with any answer. **Safety:** For under-3s, everything in the basket must be too big to fit through a toilet-paper tube. No cords or strings.



## Ready, set... go!

From 12 months · No prep · No mess

Lean a book on a cushion to make a ramp. Hold the car at the top and say “Ready, set...” and wait. When your child looks, sounds or says “Go!”, let it roll. Cheer and do it again.

### “Ready... set... (wait) GO!”

**2-minute version:** Play “ready, set, go” with tickles on the couch. **Safety:** For under-3s, toy cars and balls must be too big to fit through a toilet-paper tube.



## Color hunt

From 18 months · No prep · No mess

Pick a color together and go looking for it outside: a red car, a red door, a red leaf. Point and name each one. Then pick a new color.

### “Red! A red car. Red car going fast!”

**2-minute version:** Sit on the step and spot colors going past. **Safety:** Hold hands near roads. Check that nothing found outside goes into mouths, and dress for the weather.



## Blanket hideout

From 18 months · 2-min prep · No mess

Drape a blanket over a table or two chairs to make a hideout. Bring in a flashlight or a couple of books. Let your child decide who is allowed in and what happens inside.

### “Knock, knock! Can I come in? ... What’s the password?”

**2-minute version:** Lie under the blanket together and read one book with a flashlight. **Safety:** Use a light blanket, keep faces uncovered and stay nearby. No cords or strings tied to the den. Use a flashlight whose battery cover screws shut.

## Five small talk moves to try this week

1. **Pause and wait.** Say a little, then stop. Count to five in your head. A look, a sound, a sign, a point or a word all count as an answer.
2. **Say what you see.** Put words to what your child is doing, right as it happens. No questions needed.
3. **Repeat and add one.** Say back what your child said or showed, and add one more word or idea.
4. **Offer a choice.** Hold up two options and wait. Reaching, pointing and looking all count.
5. **Follow their lead.** Let your child choose what to do and how. Join in and copy them.

Talk, sign, sing and read in the language you know best. A sign, a point or a tap on a device counts as communicating. Reading a talk line word for word counts too.



## Want the whole month?

30 Days of Back-and-Forth: 30 short lessons by email, 30 plays, plain words for 30 tricky moments and a full workbook. \$27, with a 14-day money-back guarantee. Written program; no videos, calls or coaching.

[playbeforepixels.com/30-days](https://playbeforepixels.com/30-days)